

Fighting Fear and Lies

The world around you doesn't want you to know that becoming a millionaire is possible. We've been told lies about who millionaires are, how they act, and how they got their money. We've been told that the average millionaire has had everything handed to them on a silver platter. We've seen how Hollywood portrays the wealthy, and it leaves a sick feeling in our stomachs. We are bombarded with headlines every day that try to convince us the wealthy are the enemies of the middle class. We're told that the rich get richer off the backs of the poor. We're sold a bill of goods that entitlement programs, tax relief, Social Security, and government-run health care will take care of us. And, it seems like the younger you are, the more likely you are to believe this garbage. For example, we found that 74%—almost three out of four—of millennials believe millionaires inherited all their wealth. That's significantly more than the 52% of baby boomers who believed it. The truth is, they're both wrong—way wrong. Only 21% of millionaires received any inheritance *at all*, and only 16% inherited more than \$100,000. But wait. Let's go further. Only 3% of millionaires received an inheritance at or above \$1 million. Think about that: 74% of millennials believe millionaires inherited their millions, but the vast majority of millionaires either didn't get *any* inheritance at all or certainly didn't get enough to make them millionaires!